HANDOUT · FAITH: 101 BIBLE STUDY

METHODISM: 101

PARTS 3 & 4: WHAT METHODISTS BELIEVE

GRACE COMMUNITY CHURCH

WHEN	**Wednesday, November 11, 2026 · 7:00 PM ET**
ZOOM	**Meeting ID 880 2297 9559 · Passcode 19061906**
ALSO	Live on Facebook · all are welcome
TEACHER	Rev. Dr. Arian B. Harris

SCAN TO JOIN

How does grace change us?

Last time we told the story: how a small club at Oxford became a movement, and how Black Methodists built the AME, AME Zion and CME churches when racism pushed them out. Grace Community Church is part of the **Christian Methodist Episcopal Church**.

Tonight we look at what all of those churches still believe. John Wesley taught that God's grace is **"free in all, and free for all."** Grace goes before us, pardons us and keeps growing us until love rules our hearts.

And Methodists have always said belief has to be lived: with simple rules, steady habits, and a small group of people who ask each other, **"How is it with your soul?"**

Key Scripture. "For the grace of God has appeared that offers salvation to all people." Titus 2:11 (NIV)

WHERE WE'VE BEEN

- **1729** The "Holy Club" meets at Oxford
- **1738** Aldersgate: Wesley's heart "strangely warmed"
- **1739** Field preaching begins
- **1784** Methodist Episcopal Church founded in Baltimore
- **1816** AME Church founded in Philadelphia
- **1821** AME Zion Church organized in New York
- **1870** CME Church organized in Jackson, Tennessee
- **1968** United Methodist Church formed; Central Jurisdiction ends

Racism split the Methodist family. Black Methodists answered by building.

PART 3 · WHAT METHODISTS BELIEVE

THREE KINDS OF GRACE

Prevenient · grace that goes before. God moves first and frees us to respond. **1 John 4:19**

Justifying · grace that pardons. Forgiven, born again, and assured we belong to God. **Romans 8:16**

Sanctifying · grace that transforms. The Spirit growing us toward perfect love. **2 Corinthians 5:17**

GOING ON TO PERFECTION

Christian perfection doesn't mean never making a mistake. It means a heart so full of love for God and neighbor that love rules it. Methodist preachers are asked: **"Are you going on to perfection?"**

Wesley's picture: the **porch** is repentance, the **door** is faith, the **house** is holiness. Don't live on the porch; don't stop at the door.

Matthew 22:37–39

PART 4 · HOW METHODISTS LIVE

THREE SIMPLE RULES · THE GENERAL RULES, 1743

Do no harm Romans 12:9 · **Do good** Galatians 6:10 · **Stay in love with God** John 15:5

THE MEANS OF GRACE

WORKS OF PIETY · LOVING GOD

Prayer · Scripture · Holy Communion · Fasting · Holy conversation

WORKS OF MERCY · LOVING NEIGHBOR

Feeding the hungry · Visiting the sick and those in prison · Caring for the poor

These don't earn grace. They are where God has promised to meet us.

THE CLASS MEETING

Every early Methodist met weekly in a **class** of about a dozen people (Bristol, 1742) to ask: **"How is it with your soul?"** James 5:16

THE WESLEYAN QUADRILATERAL · SCRIPTURE FIRST

1 Scripture 2 Tim 3:16–17 · **2 Tradition** 2 Thess 2:15 · **3 Reason** Isaiah 1:18 · **4 Experience** Romans 8:16

THIS WEEK: PUT YOURSELF IN GRACE'S WAY

Pick one specific action for each, then check off each day you practice it. Bring your story next Wednesday.

PRACTICE	MY ACTION THIS WEEK	TH	F	SA	SU	M	TU	W
A work of piety 10 minutes of prayer, or a psalm a day								
A work of mercy One person to help, by name								
Ask the question "How is it with your soul?"								

Pray this week: God of free grace, you found us before we knew your name. Keep us going on to perfection.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Use these in class, in a small group or on your own this week; the letters match the slides. ★ marks the core questions.

A OPENING ★

Last time we tried three simple rules: do no harm, do good, stay in love with God. What happened when you tried one?

"Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says." **James 1:22 (NIV)**

B PART 3 ★

Which do you most need right now: grace that finds you (prevenient), grace that forgives you (justifying), or grace that grows you (sanctifying)?

C PART 3

Looking back, where can you see that God's grace went before you, before you knew to look for it?

"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you." **Jeremiah 1:5 (NIV)**

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS (CONTINUED)

D

PART 4

Who is your "class"? Who asks you, "How is it with your soul?" And whom do you ask?

"Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed." **James 5:16 (NIV)**

E

PART 4 ★

Which of the three simple rules is hardest for you right now? What would practicing it look like this week?

"He has shown you, O mortal, what is good." **Micah 6:8 (NIV)**

F

PART 4 ★

Try the Quadrilateral: should I forgive someone who hasn't apologized?

"Lord, how many times shall I forgive…? Jesus answered, 'I tell you, not seven times, but seventy-seven times.'" **Matthew 18:21–22 (NIV)**

SCRIPTURE	**TRADITION**	**REASON**	**EXPERIENCE**
What does the Bible say?	What has the church taught?	What makes sense here?	What have you lived?

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